

Visual Design (VD)

- 1) Create visual hierarchy to guide users' attention and prioritize important information.
Use contrast and balance to create visually pleasing compositions.
- 2) Design for readability, considering factors such as font size, line spacing & contrast.
- 3) Use imagery & graphics effectively to enhance the UX & communicate messages.
- 4) Ensure consistency in visual elements throughout the interface to create a unified and coherent (clear) design.
- 5) Considering the principles of color, typography, layout, and imagery.

VD Elements: Visual design's key elements are color, typography, and layout. Each element has its own characteristics & values that can significantly influence the overall user experience.

Color: explore color theory, color psychology & the use of color to communicate meaning & evoke emotions. Select right and trendy color palettes & combinations.

Typography: understand the role of typography in VD. Learn about font selection, font pairing, hierarchy, and legibility to effectively convey information & enhance readability.

Layout: the principles of layout design includes grids, alignment and visual flow. Learn the balanced & visually pleasing compositions by organizing elements within the layout.

Visual Hierarchy: Its role is to guide users' attention & understanding. Learn techniques to create a clear visual hierarchy, such as using size, contrast, & positioning. By hierarchy, designers can prioritize key elements & guide users through interface.

Contrast and Visual Balance: learn about the use of contrast to create emphasis & differentiate elements. Understand how contrast affects readability, visibility, & the overall visual appeal of a design. Additionally, explore the concept of “visual balance” and “how to distribute elements evenly within a design”.

Designing for Accessibility: learn considerations such as color contrast, font size & readability for users with visual impairments or other accessibility needs. Designing with accessibility in mind ensures that the design is usable & inclusive for all users.

Tasks (with report and Figma):

1. Design Exercise: Visual Hierarchy

Students will be given a webpage or app screen design with various elements. Their task is to create a visual hierarchy by using size, contrast, and positioning to guide users' attention to the most important elements.

Report: Students will present their designs and explain the reasoning behind their visual hierarchy choices.

2. Color Scheme Exploration

Students will experiment with different color schemes (e.g., monochromatic, complementary, analogous) for a given design. They will evaluate the visual impact and emotional response evoked by each color scheme.

Report: Students will present their findings and discuss the effectiveness of different color schemes for specific design contexts.

3. Typography and Readability Analysis

Students will analyze the readability and legibility (clear and understandable) of different typography choices in a provided design. They will assess the effectiveness of font selection, font pairing, hierarchy, and other typography elements.

Report: Students will present their analysis and provide recommendations for improving the typography in the design.

4. Layout Design Critique

Review & critique a provided design layout in terms of grid usage, alignment, visual flow, & overall composition. Identify strengths & areas for improvement in layout.

Report: Students will provide constructive feedback and suggest modifications to enhance the visual appeal and user experience of the design.

5. Accessibility Evaluation

Students will assess a design for its accessibility considerations, such as color contrast, font size, and readability. They will identify any potential accessibility barriers and propose solutions to improve accessibility.

Report: Students will present their evaluation findings and discuss the importance of designing for inclusivity.